

ICE BREAKERS

ICE BREAKERS FOR YOUR SESSIONS

50 questions to get the conversation truly flowing.

Starting a conversation in a new language gives you butterflies — everyone has been there. This guide brings together questions tested in real Language Exchange meetups, organized into 4 blocks that follow the natural rhythm of a session: from the first "hello" to deeper conversations. Choose 5 or 6 before starting and let the conversation take over.

50 QUESTIONS IN 4 BLOCKS

BLOCK 01 • START

To start lightly

BLOCK 02 • LIFESTYLE

To discover what you have in common

BLOCK 03 • DREAMS

To spark the imagination

BLOCK 04 • PURPOSE

For deeper conversations

HOW TO USE — PRACTICAL TIP

Treat it as a conversation, not a questionnaire. The fun isn't in asking all the questions, but in going deep into the ones that spark a connection. When your partner answers, reply with a "why?" or share your own answer before moving on. If a topic dies down, jump to another block without guilt — that's how real conversation works!

Warm-up

The first few minutes set the tone. Take it easy — listening is as important as speaking.

BLOCK 01 • START

To start lightly

The first 5 minutes. Take a deep breath, smile, and use these to loosen your tongue.

ABOUT LANGUAGES & CULTURES

- What made you decide to learn this language?
- Which word do you find most beautiful (or funniest) in my language?
- Have you ever traveled to a country that speaks the language you're practicing?
- What is the hardest part for you in this new language?
- If you could magically learn any language in the world, which would you choose?

DAILY LIFE & ROUTINE

- How has your day been so far? Busy or relaxed?
- What is your favorite part of the week?
- Are you an early bird or a night owl?
- Is there a daily habit you can't live without?
- How is the weather in your city today?

BLOCK 02 • LIFESTYLE

To discover what you have in common

When the conversation is already flowing. This is where the best stories come up.

ENTERTAINMENT & MEDIA

- What was the last TV show, movie, or book that truly hooked you?
- Do you enjoy music more in your native language or in other languages?
- Is there a podcast or YouTube channel you follow all the time?
- Which movie from your childhood would you watch again right now?
- If your life were turned into a movie, what genre would it be?

FOOD & FLAVORS

- What typical dish from your region should I definitely try?
- Do you prefer cooking or ordering delivery?
- Which international cuisine is your favorite?
- Is there any food that you simply don't like?
- What does a typical breakfast look like at your home?

Going deeper

When the talk is already flowing, make room for dreams, journeys, and what truly matters.

BLOCK 03 • DREAMS

To spark the imagination

When there is enough trust for more elaborate and fun answers.

TRAVEL & DESTINATIONS

- Which trip remained forever marked in your memory?
- If you won a free plane ticket tomorrow, where would you go?
- Do you prefer the beach and heat, or cold weather and mountains?
- Which tourist spot in your city would you recommend with your eyes closed?
- Do you prefer traveling alone or in a group?

WHAT IF... (HYPOTHETICALS)

- Which person, living or deceased, would you have dinner with today?
- If you could choose any superpower, what would it be?
- Which profession would you test for a week, just out of curiosity?
- If you could live in another era, which one would you go to?
- Which object or technology would you bring to a deserted island?

BLOCK 04 • PURPOSE

For deeper conversations

Journeys, causes, and impact. Fits right in with the Shapers vibe.

CAREER & STUDIES

- What do you work with or study nowadays?
- What is your favorite part of what you do?
- How do you imagine yourself 5 years from now?
- What was the best professional advice you've ever received?
- If you weren't in this field, what would you be doing?

CAUSES & IMPACT

- Is there a social project or cause that moves you?
- How did you hear about Language Exchange or the local community?
- What change would you most like to see in your city?
- Which new skill would you like to learn or teach?
- What was the last collective or volunteer action that inspired you?

**Leftover questions? Save them for the next meetup.
Book a new match on the Language Exchange platform**